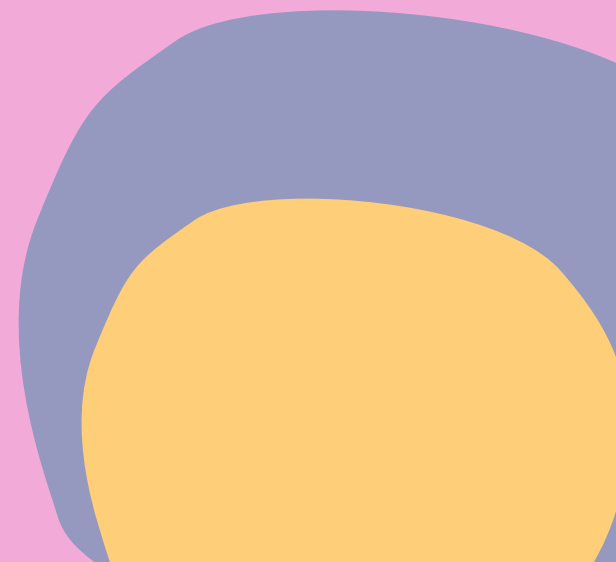


# Breastfeeding 101

With Leanne @birth-  
hood, qualified  
doula, and  
hypnobirthing  
instructor.



# What is your goal?



In the UK, around 80% of people begin breastfeeding, and yet by 6 months, that drops to below 1%. The vast majority of people who stop breastfeeding say that they did so despite wanting to continue. In the UK we have the lowest breastfeeding rates in the world. This course is designed to help prepare you to reach your goals.

**What do you know?**

**Has anyone around you fed before?**

**How do you feel about feeding?**

# Why breastfeed?

Improve health for the  
parent.

Improve health for  
baby.

Spend less money  
(aside late night online  
purchases!).

Easier long term.



# So why do people stop?

Lack of support.

Too many myths.

**PAIN**

Society being shit.

**I wanted to go  
out for drinks,  
so stopped.**



**My bounty pack had  
lots from  
SMA/Aptamil and  
they're so close to  
human milk now.**



**Should you be allowed to  
feed your baby when  
they are hungry? Also,  
stay at home parents  
drain the economy.**

**My boobs  
were ruined  
after feeding.**



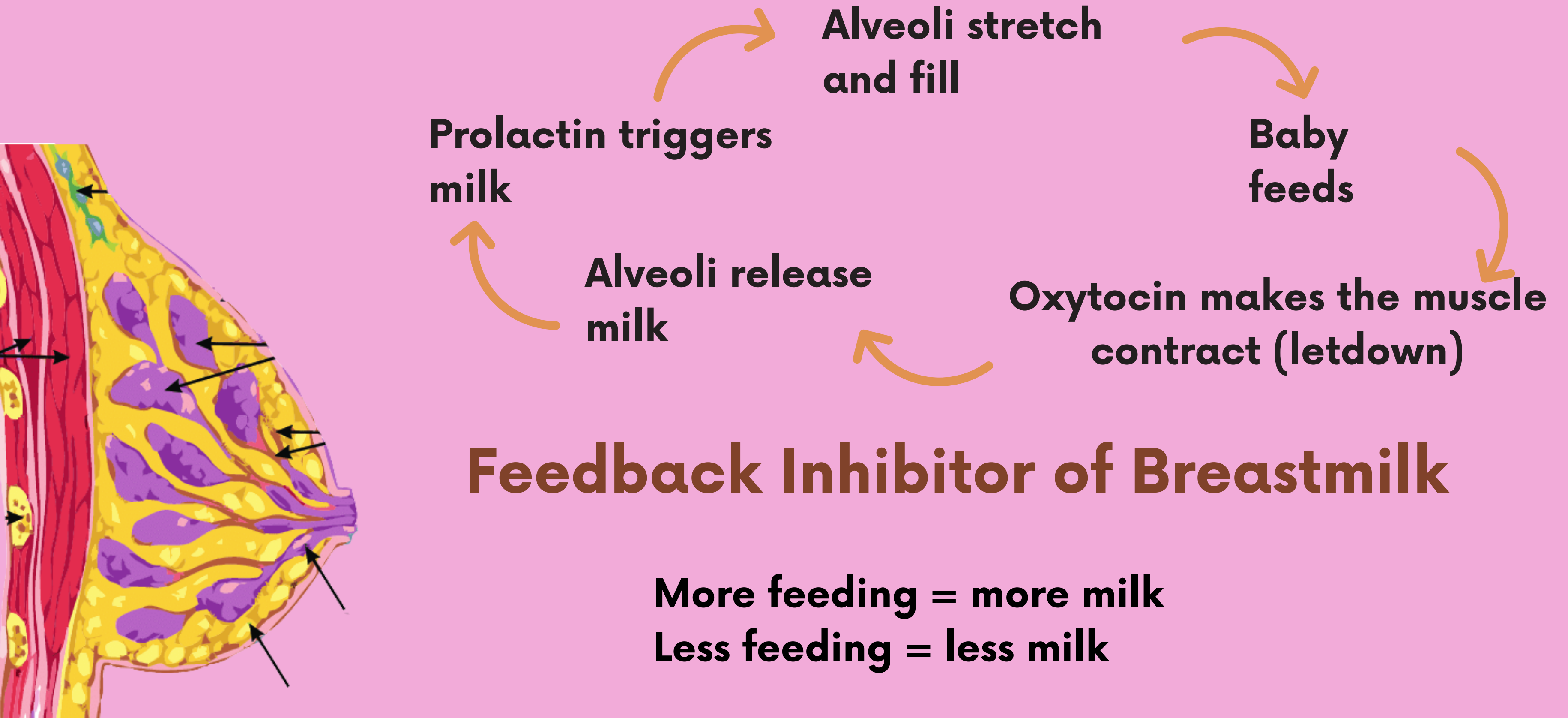
**Be prepared, it is  
SO painful. I was  
bleeding for days.**



**I couldn't do much for  
you and your brother  
as your mum wanted  
to breastfeed you  
both.**



# How the milk makers make milk.





# Breasts are like rivers, not lakes.

If it rains more, the river flows faster, if there is a drought, the river may dry up. As soon as rain comes, the river flows again.



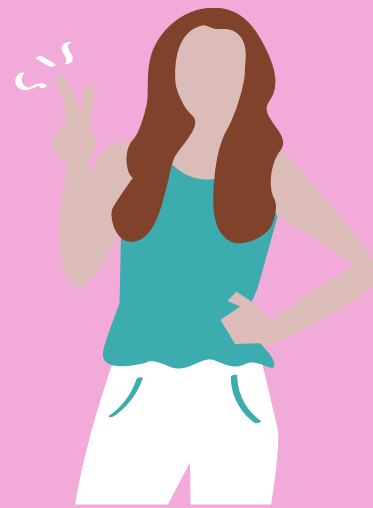
**WHICH MEANS...**

...Once baby has fed, there will still be milk. Breasts won't empty nor do you have to wait a certain amount of time for them to "fill up".

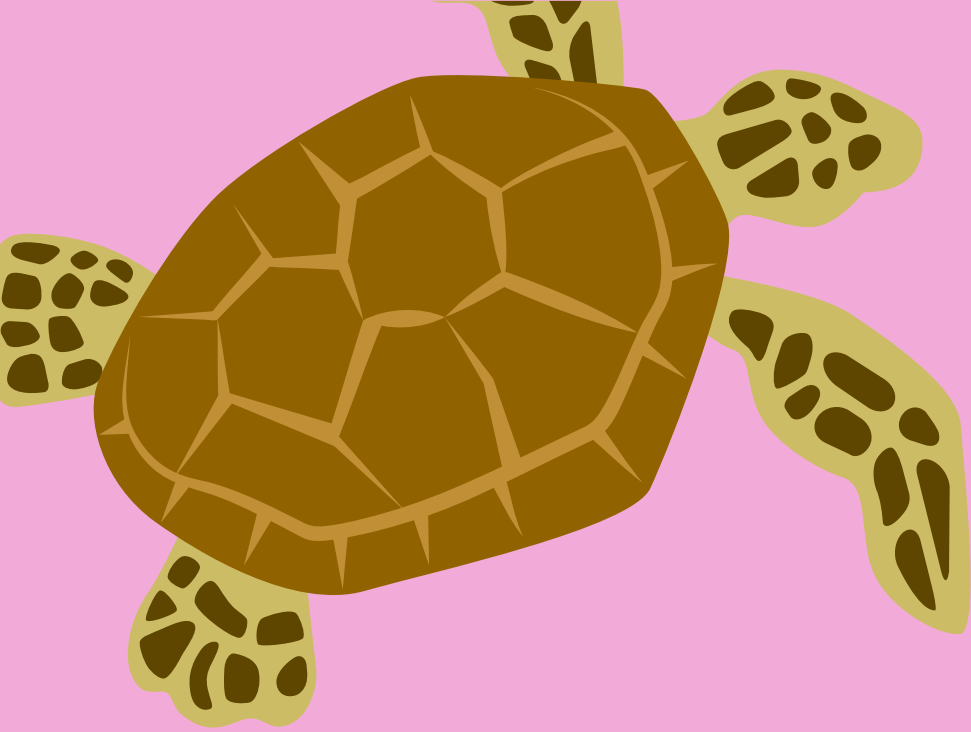


# Normal Newborn Behaviour

"Sleep like a  
baby  
Sleeping  
through  
Rod for your  
own back  
Self soothe"



- ✓ Babies wake often.
- ✓ 100% of babies that have been breastfed responsively will be independent adults.
- ✓ Self soothing is an unrealistic expectation.



# Humans are born too soon.

But  
why?



Waking often.

- Reduces the risk of SIDS.
- Prolactin is higher at night, night feeding increases supply.
- They need to acquire a circadian rhythm.

Independence:

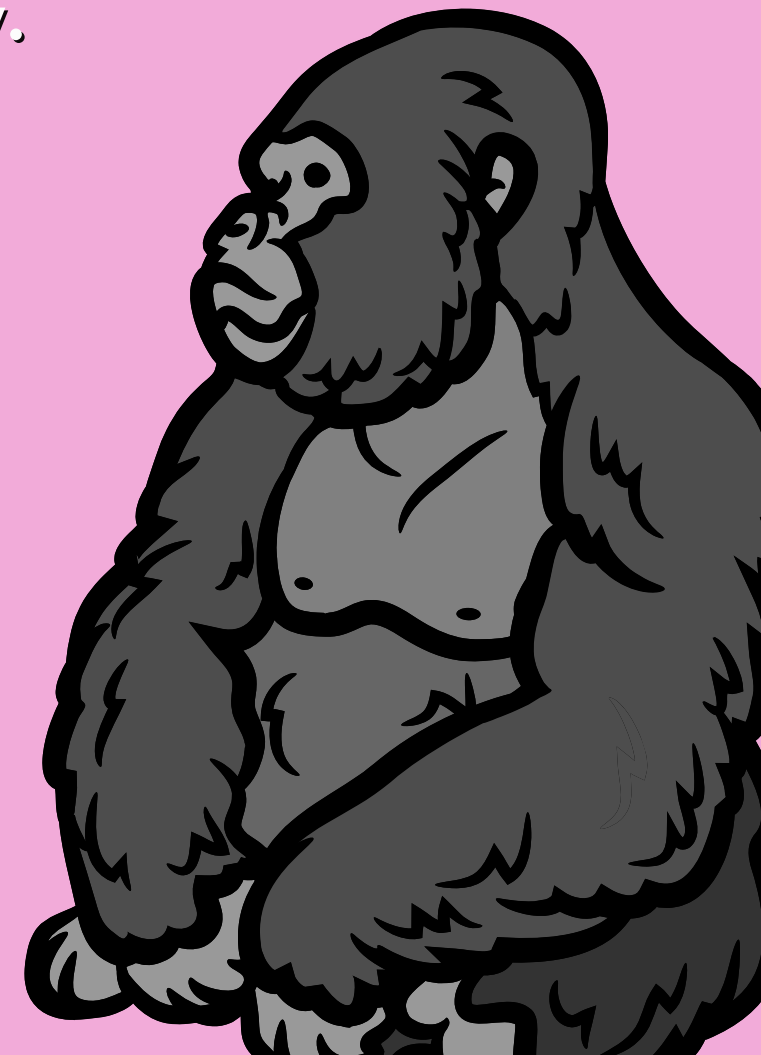
- Research shows that responsively parented children actually become more independent as they grow.
- 22 month pregnancy to 9 month pregnancy.

Self soothing:

- Isn't actually soothing, but a shift in energy use.
- Can interfere with breastfeeding.
- Causes more stress for the family.

Feeding often:

- Increases supply.
- Allows parent to rest and recover.
- Is healthier.
- Avoids mastitis.





# Feeding frequency

**WOMB: 24 hours a day, all day, every day, constantly feeding.**

**We expect 8-12 times in 24 hours AT LEAST.**

**Breastmilk digests quickly.**

**Stomach is small.**

**Fourth Trimester.**

# Feeding cues

**Being awake.**

**Hands to mouth.**

**Rooting.**

**Crying is a LATE sign.**

**CLUSTER  
FEEDING**

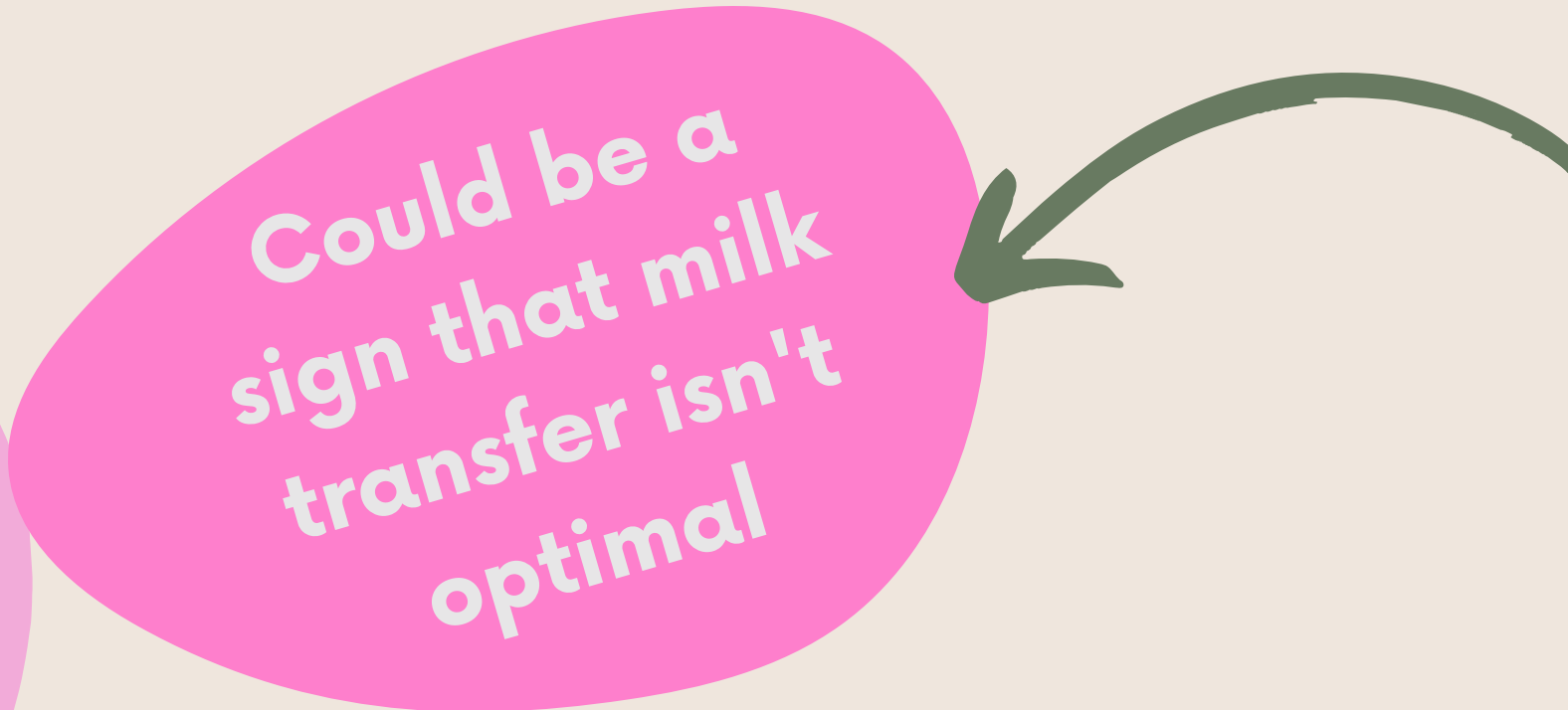


# Is baby getting enough milk?

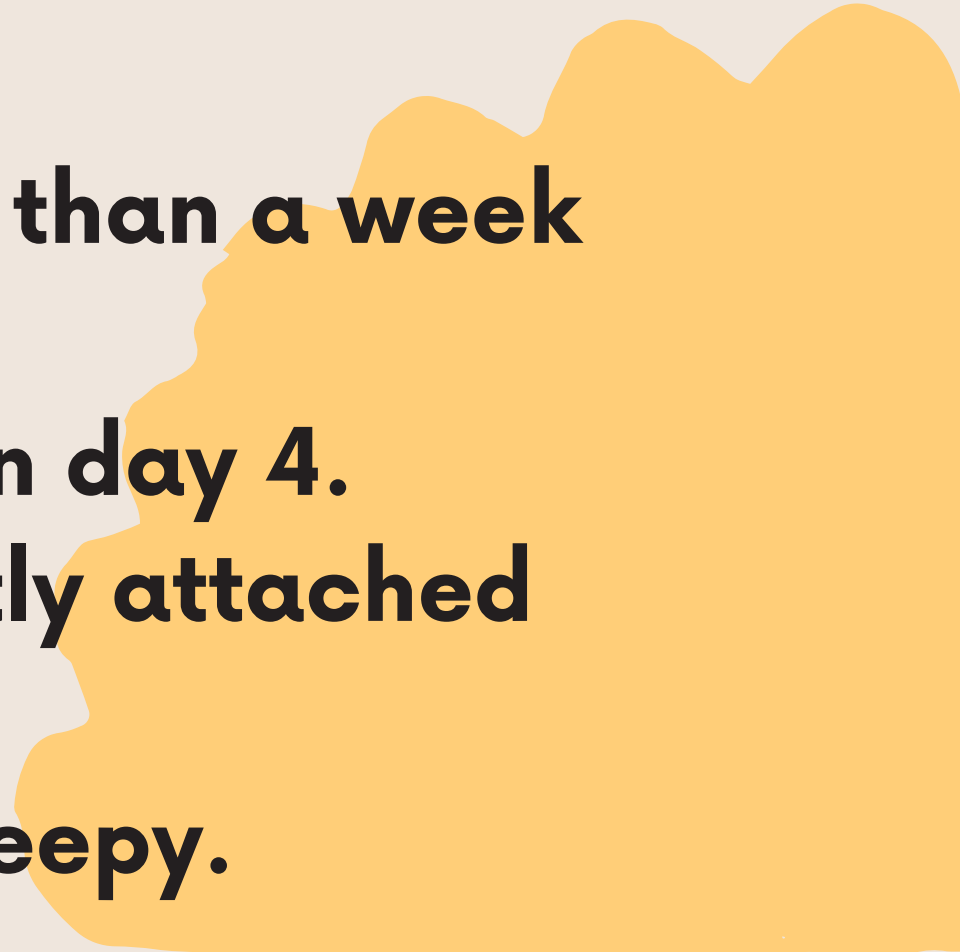
- Baby has one poo on day one, two on day two, three on day three.....
- Baby wants feeding whenever they are awake.
- Baby wakes often in the night.
- Baby doesn't want to be put down.

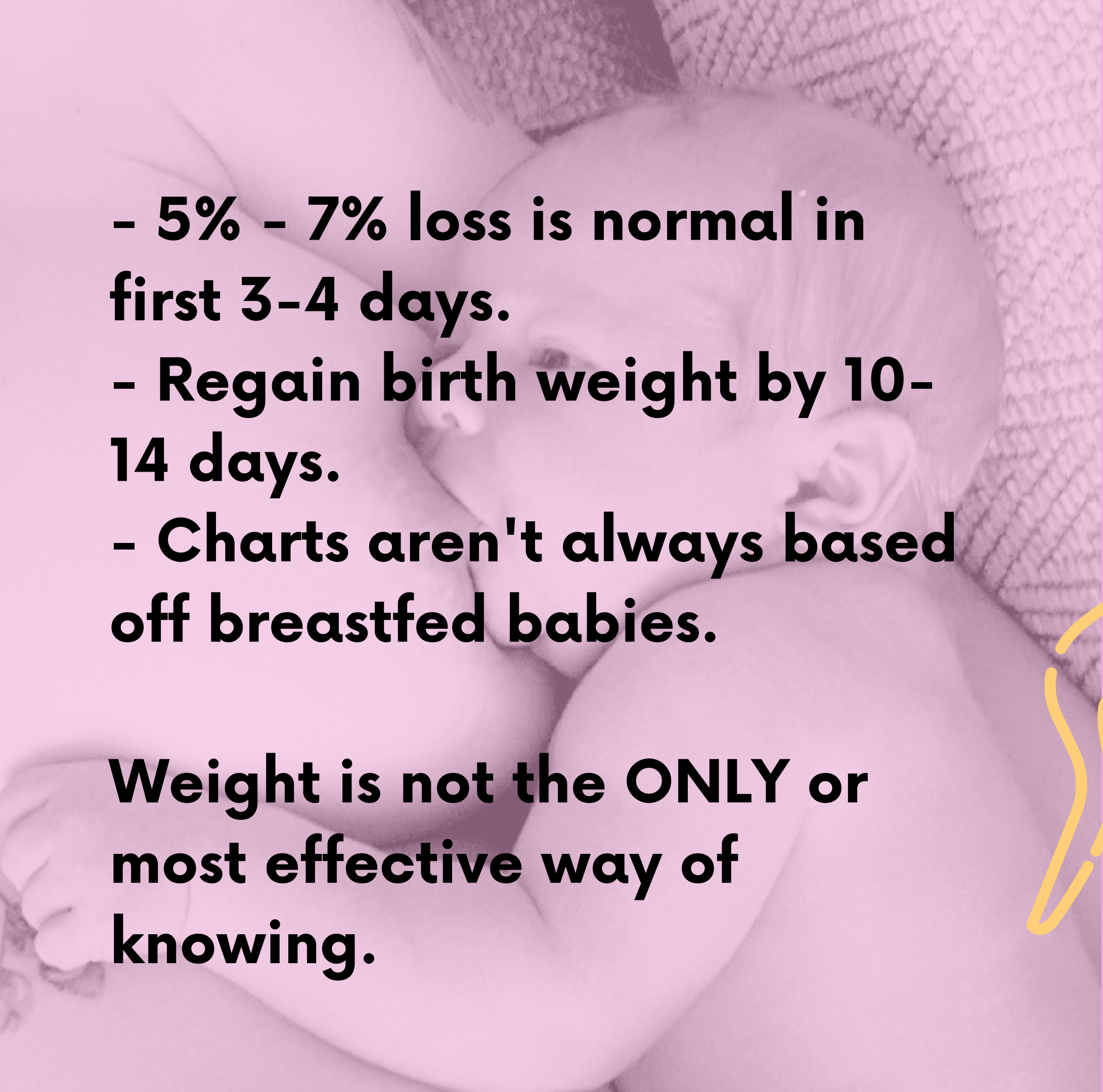


NOT a sign of  
not enough  
milk



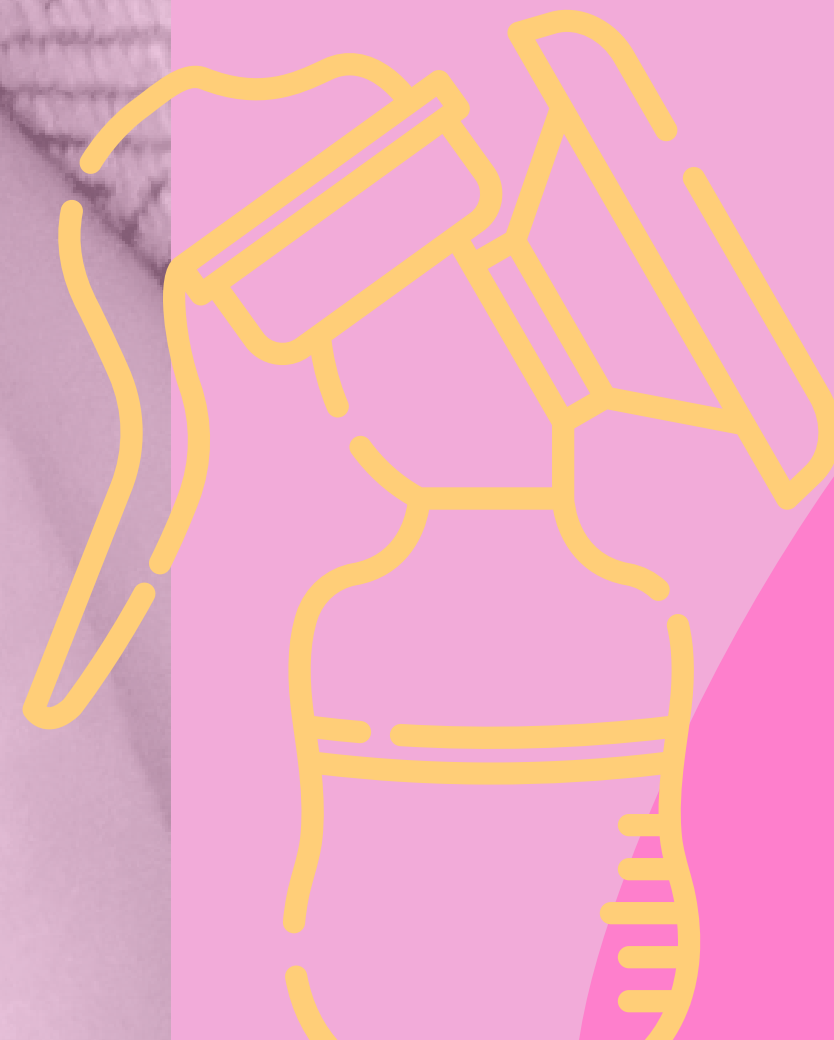
Could be a  
sign that milk  
transfer isn't  
optimal

- 
- Baby goes more than a week without pooing.
  - Baby loses 9% on day 4.
  - Baby is constantly attached (literally).
  - Baby is overly sleepy.

- 
- 5% - 7% loss is normal in first 3-4 days.
  - Regain birth weight by 10-14 days.
  - Charts aren't always based off breastfed babies.

**Weight is not the ONLY or most effective way of knowing.**

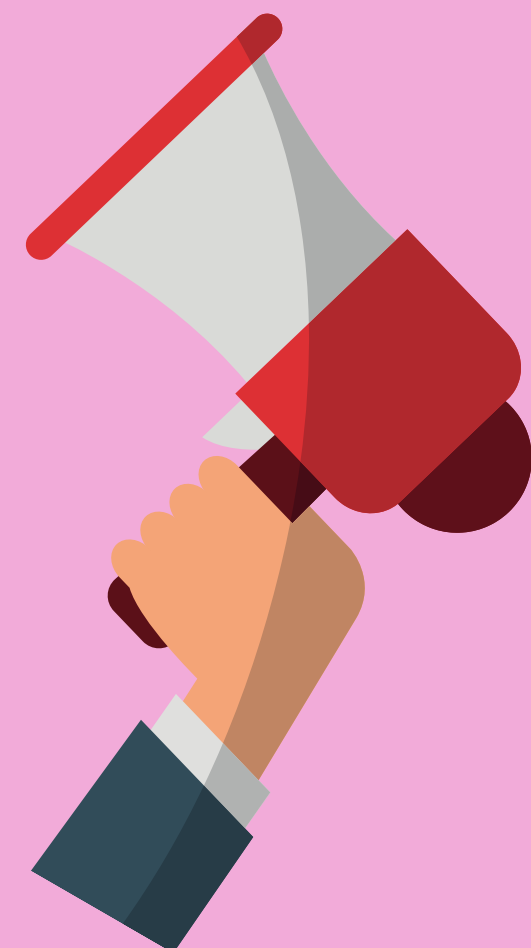
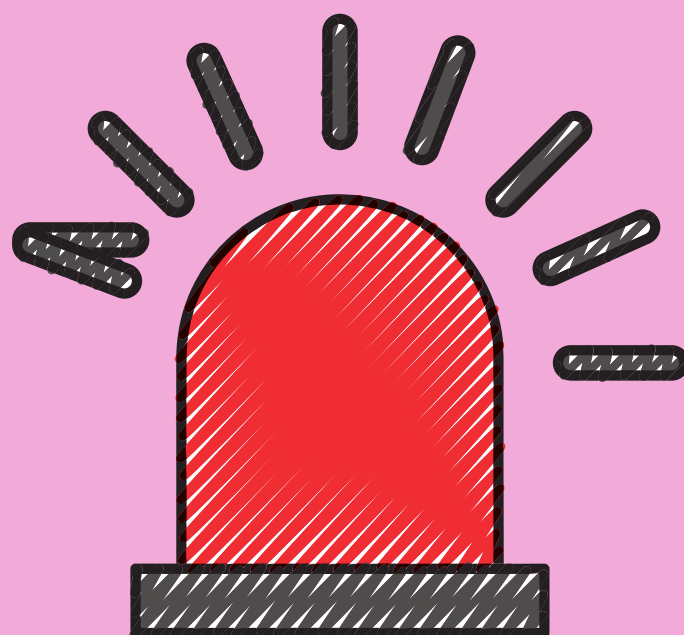
# **Weight gain.**



**SHOULD I PUMP  
TO CHECK  
MILK?  
Pumping is NOT  
an indication of  
supply.**



# POO ALERT





# Nappies.



**DAY 1**  
**0-12 hours**







**DAY 1 - 2**







**DAY 3**



**DAY 4**





**Day 5 - 7**



# How is baby latched?



**Head resting on forearm.**

**Free movement of head.**

**Nose "going up" nipple.**

**Imaginary line from nipple out of crown of head.**

# PAIN

**ANY pain needs to be investigated, even if you are told the latch "looks fine".**

- **Getting a DEEP latch.**  
(Breast feeding, not nipple feeding.)
- **Unlatch as soon as pain appears.**
- **Trying different positions.**
- **Getting qualified support.**





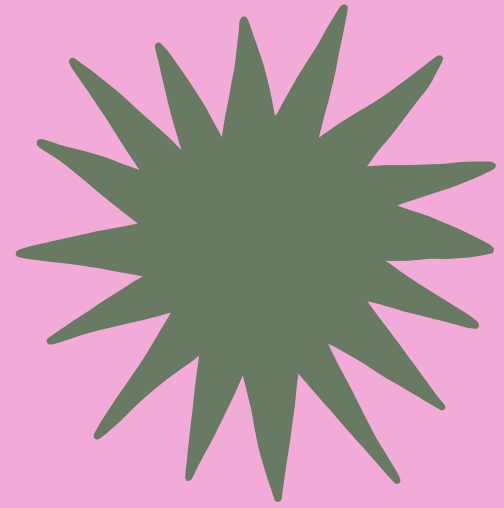
**Engorgement, baby feeding often, leaking.**

**Weeks 2-4. Breasts feel soft sometimes. Feeding might have a routine, not a schedule.**

- Same time every day. Fussiness. Baby seems "in pain, sad, hungry, unhappy".

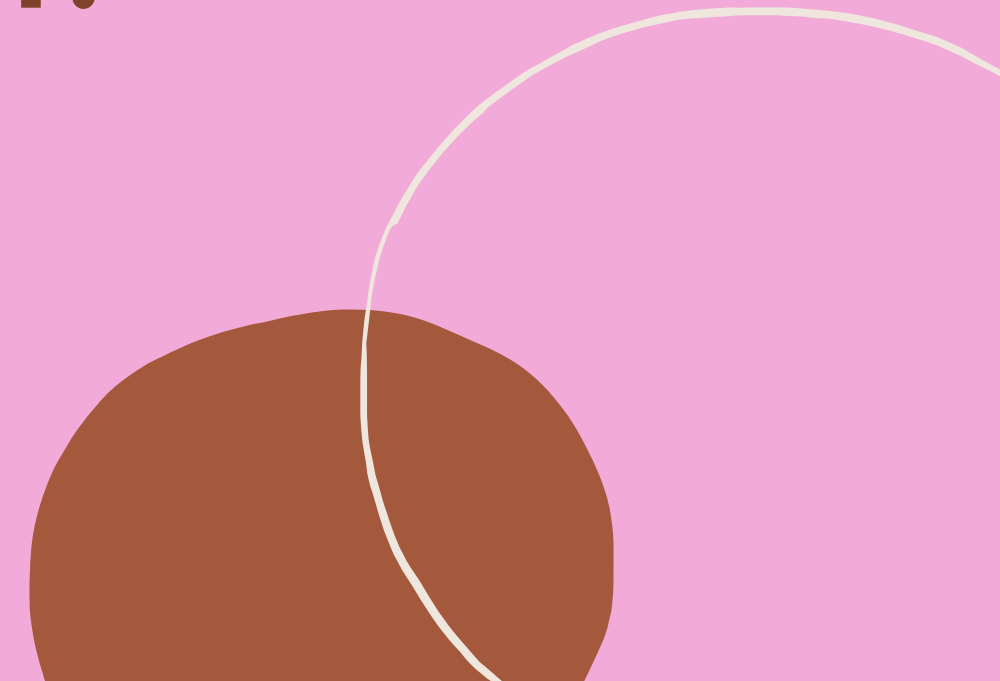
**Baby blues. Sadness. Rage.  
Frustration. Intrusive  
thoughts. Feeding and post  
natal mental health.**

Oh we have got it.....oh  
wait, back to cluster  
feeding. Developmental  
leaps. Calorie



# Who can help?

- Midwife.
- National Breastfeeding helpline.
  - Free support groups
- In home support from a postnatal doula/ Breastfeeding Counsellor.
  - IBCLC.





# How can partners help?

- Be the "Boob Bouncer".
- Feed and water the "feeder".
- Do nappy changes. Babywear.
- Bath baby.
- Baby massage.
- Encourage and support.

## Family?

- Bring food.
- Offer to care for older children.
- Be respectful when visiting.
- Hold hands, not the baby.
- Do a task on a visit.
- Gift a doula visit/IBCLC appt if needed.

# RESOURCES

**National Breastfeeding Helpline (0300 100 0212).**

**BfN Drugs in Breastmilk (<https://www.breastfeedingnetwork.org.uk/detailed-information/drugs-in-breastmilk/>)**

**Find an IBCLC (<https://lcgb.org/find-an-ibclc/>)**

**Find a tongue tie practitioner ( <https://www.tongue-tie.org.uk/find-a-practitioner/>)**

**Facebook: UK Breastfeeding and Parenting Support.  
Biologically normal infant sleep.**